



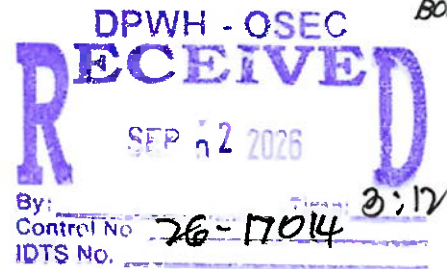
Republic of the Philippines
DEPARTMENT OF PUBLIC WORKS AND HIGHWAYS
OFFICE OF THE SECRETARY
DPWH Central Office, Bonifacio Drive, Port Area, Manila



SEP 04 2026

MEMORANDUM

TO : ALL CONCERNED



SUBJECT : OPERATIONAL FRAMEWORK OF OPLAN KONTRA BAHÁ

I. POLICY AND PROGRAM FRAMEWORK

Pursuant to Presidential Directive No. PBBM-2025-1777-1780 dated November 19, 2025, DPWH Special Order No. 06, s. 2026 and pertinent department issuances, as well as other applicable laws, rules, regulations, the Department of Public Works and Highways (DPWH) shall institutionalize Oplan Kontra Baha (OKB) as a regular and sustained flood mitigation and maintenance program of the Department.

OKB shall provide a coordinated, systematic, and risk-based mechanism for the identification, assessment, prioritization, implementation, monitoring, and sustained maintenance interventions intended to restore and preserve the functionality and carrying capacity of waterways, drainage systems, and flood control facilities, particularly in flood-prone and frequently inundated areas.

OKB shall focus on maximizing the functionality of existing waterways, drainage systems, and flood control facilities through preventive, corrective, responsive, and sustained maintenance interventions.

Where flooding is attributable to inadequate infrastructure capacity, major structural deficiencies, right-of-way constraints, land-use conditions, watershed degradation, or other causes beyond the scope of regular maintenance operations, OKB shall serve as a mechanism for identifying, documenting, and referring such conditions for appropriate engineering, policy, enforcement, or inter-agency action.

II. GUIDING PRINCIPLES

A. Ridge-to-Reef Approach

OKB shall recognize the hydrologic and environmental interconnection among upland areas, watersheds, tributaries, rivers, creeks, drainage systems, floodplains, estuaries, coastal areas, and receiving bodies of water. Interventions shall, whenever practicable, consider upstream and downstream conditions and shall avoid merely transferring flooding, siltation, solid waste, or other problems to another area.

B. Whole-of-Nation Approach

OKB shall promote coordinated action among government agencies, local government units, communities, the private sector, and other stakeholders, while respecting their respective mandates, jurisdictions, authorities, and accountabilities.

C. Risk-Based Prioritization

Available resources shall be directed toward interventions having the greatest potential benefit in terms of flood-risk reduction, public safety, population affected, protection of critical facilities, restoration of hydraulic functionality, and operational urgency.

D. Preventive and Sustained Maintenance

OKB shall prioritize preventive and periodic maintenance. Completed interventions shall, as appropriate, be incorporated into a continuing monitoring and maintenance cycle.

E. Evidence-Based Decision-Making

Planning, prioritization, deployment, accomplishment reporting, and evaluation shall be supported by actual and verifiable field data, including field inspection, measurements, geotagged photographs, flood information, equipment records, and accomplishment quantities.

F. Accountability and Data Integrity

All OKB accomplishments shall be reported using accurate, consistent, measurable, and verifiable data corresponding to actual field conditions and documented operations.

G. Environmental Responsibility

OKB operations shall comply with applicable environmental, water, solid waste management, easement, disposal, occupational safety, and other relevant laws, rules, regulations, and permitting requirements.

H. Complementarity of Maintenance and Structural Measures

OKB shall complement, and shall not substitute for, necessary structural flood control and drainage interventions. Conditions that cannot reasonably be addressed through maintenance shall be documented and referred for appropriate structural or policy intervention.

III. OBJECTIVES

The OKB shall pursue the following objectives:

1. Restore and maintain the carrying capacity and functionality of waterways, drainage systems, and flood control facilities;
2. Remove silt, solid waste, debris, vegetation, and other obstructions that restrict or impede the conveyance and discharge of water;
3. Reduce, to the extent practicable, the duration, extent, frequency, and impacts of flooding through appropriate maintenance and operational interventions;
4. Institutionalize regular, preventive, and condition-based maintenance instead of relying primarily on reactive interventions after flooding occurs;
5. Establish a systematic, objective, and risk-based mechanism for identifying and prioritizing areas requiring intervention;

6. Promote coordinated and complementary action among DPWH offices, national government agencies, local government units, private-sector partners, communities, and other stakeholders;
7. Promote proper solid waste management and environmental protection as integral components of sustainable flood mitigation;
8. Establish uniform, measurable, accurate, and verifiable accomplishment and performance indicators for OKB operations;
9. Strengthen monitoring of completed interventions and establish appropriate maintenance cycles to prevent or minimize recurrence of obstruction and deterioration; and
10. Identify and elevate structural, systemic, jurisdictional, environmental, and other conditions that cannot be adequately addressed through regular OKB operations.

IV. SCOPE OF INTERVENTIONS

A. Waterway Restoration and Maintenance

1. Dredging and desilting of rivers, creeks, esteros, channels, and other waterways;
2. Removal of accumulated solid waste, debris, vegetation, and other obstructions;
3. Clearing of waterway sections necessary to restore or improve conveyance;
4. Removal or appropriate treatment of obstructions affecting water flow, subject to applicable laws and permits; and
5. Minor restoration or rehabilitation works necessary to restore waterway functionality.

These activities intrinsically necessitate the strategic deployment of both land-based and water-based dredging equipment (such as amphibious excavators, multi-purpose amphibious dredgers, trash skimmers, and cutter suction dredgers). Furthermore, to maximize equipment utilization and operational windows, these operations entail the hiring and mobilization of additional manpower to sustain multiple or extended operational shifts.

B. Drainage System Maintenance

1. Declogging and cleaning of drainage lines;
2. Cleaning and desilting of manholes, catch basins, inlets, outfalls, culverts, and similar drainage facilities;
3. Removal of obstructions at drainage outlets and discharge points;
4. Maintenance of open drainage channels;
5. Identification, documentation, and endorsement of drainage facilities requiring repair, rehabilitation, improvement, or upgrading for appropriate action in accordance with D.O. No. 132, s. 2025 and other applicable Department policies; and
6. Identification and documentation of drainage bottlenecks requiring major engineering intervention.

These require the coordinated deployment of specialized declogging and hauling equipment, such as vacuum sewer jet cleaner, water tank truck, small backhoes, dump trucks, etc. Crucially, given the spatial constraints and the general inaccessibility of most drainage networks to heavy machinery, these activities necessitate the extensive mobilization of manual labor. Thus hiring of additional manpower is an indispensable component of OKB.

C. Flood Control Facility Rehabilitation and Maintenance

OKB may undertake or coordinate appropriate maintenance of existing flood control facilities and appurtenant structures where obstruction or operational deficiencies adversely affect their intended function. Conditions involving structural deterioration, damage, or deficiencies requiring repair, rehabilitation, improvement, or upgrading shall be identified and endorsed for appropriate action in accordance with D.O. No. 132, s. 2025 and other applicable Department policies.

OKB shall likewise include the maintenance, operational readiness, and proper utilization of DPWH-managed pumping and booster stations, including the strategic deployment of mobile pumps wherever technically applicable. Deployment and operations shall be based on site conditions, pumping requirements, equipment capacity, safe discharge locations, and available resources, and shall be coordinated with the concerned DPWH Implementing Offices, LGUs, and partner agencies to ensure effective and timely flood mitigation operations.

D. Solid Waste and Environmental Management

OKB operations shall integrate appropriate solid waste and environmental management measures consistent with Republic Act No. 9003 and other applicable laws.

1. Solid waste, debris, silt, and other materials removed in the course of OKB operations shall be collected, hauled, and lawfully disposed of in coordination with concerned LGUs, DENR, MMDA, other government agencies, and authorized disposal facilities, as applicable.
2. Nothing herein shall be construed as transferring to DPWH the general responsibility for municipal solid waste management. However, when necessary to ensure the timely and continuous implementation of OKB operations, DPWH may undertake or procure the collection, hauling, transfer, and lawful disposal of materials removed or generated from OKB intervention areas, subject to applicable laws, rules, and regulations.
3. Recurring solid waste accumulation points shall be identified and coordinated with the concerned LGU or responsible agency for appropriate source-control, waste interception, and solid waste management measures.
4. Environmental safeguards shall be observed during dredging, desilting, clearing, hauling, temporary staging, and disposal operations.
5. Environmental violations, unlawful dumping, easement obstructions, encroachments, and similar conditions affecting waterway functionality shall be documented and referred to the proper authority.

E. Assessment, Monitoring, and Maintenance

OKB shall include regular inspection and assessment of waterways, drainage systems, and flood control facilities before and after intervention and periodic monitoring of completed areas to determine succeeding maintenance requirements.

F. Research and Development

OKB shall promote the development, testing, and evaluation of practical, cost-effective, scalable, and technically suitable alternative interventions, including the use of innovative materials, methods, and technologies that may provide comparable or improved performance over conventional approaches. Such interventions shall address immediate or short-term needs while supporting, complementing, or serving as preparatory components of sustainable long-term solutions. Technically validated approaches may be standardized, replicated, or

integrated into long-term flood mitigation and waterway management measures, subject to applicable laws, standards, and Department policies.

V. GOVERNANCE AND ORGANIZATIONAL STRUCTURE

A. Secretary of Public Works and Highways

The Secretary shall exercise overall policy direction and supervision over OKB. Major policy matters, resource requirements, and issues requiring Department-level or inter-agency action shall be elevated to the Secretary.

B. OKB Task Force

The Task Force, as constituted under Special Order No. 06, s. 2026, and subsequent amendatory or related issuances, shall serve as the principal coordinating and oversight mechanism for the Department-wide implementation of OKB.

Specifically, the Task Force shall:

1. Provide overall operational coordination for OKB implementation;
2. Establish or recommend operational priorities for critical, urgent, inter-regional, or multi-agency concerns;
3. Coordinate the mobilization and augmentation of equipment, personnel, technical expertise, logistics, and other available resources;
4. Facilitate inter-office, inter-agency, LGU, and private-sector coordination;
5. Monitor implementation of priority interventions and commitments;
6. Identify and facilitate resolution of operational constraints that cannot be adequately addressed at the District or Regional level;
7. Establish or recommend uniform operational, monitoring, documentation, and reporting standards;
8. Consolidate and evaluate OKB accomplishments, resource utilization, operational constraints, and performance;
9. Identify recurring, systemic, or structural flooding concerns requiring further engineering, policy, enforcement, or programmatic intervention; and
10. Submit appropriate reports, assessments, and recommendations to the Secretary.

The composition, leadership, powers, and specific authorities of the Task Force shall remain governed by Special Order No. 06, s. 2026 and other pertinent department issuances.

C. Task Force Commander

The Task Force Commander, as designated under the applicable Special Order or Department issuance, shall exercise the functions and authorities assigned thereto under such issuance and shall coordinate the overall implementation of OKB. Nothing in this Framework shall be construed as expanding the authority of the Task Force Commander beyond that provided under applicable laws and Department issuances.

D. Task Force Secretariat and Technical Working Group

The office or unit designated under the applicable Special Order or subsequent Department issuance shall provide secretariat, technical, monitoring, administrative, and coordination support to the OKB Task Force, including consolidation of reports, maintenance of program data, tracking of directives and commitments, and preparation of situation and accomplishment reports.

E. Regional Director

The Regional Director, being the Regional OKB Task Group Commander, shall exercise regional-level supervision and coordination of OKB implementation within his/her jurisdiction, including consolidation and validation of priority interventions, coordination among District Engineering Offices, facilitation of resource augmentation, monitoring of accomplishments, and elevation of unresolved requirements to the OKB Task Force.

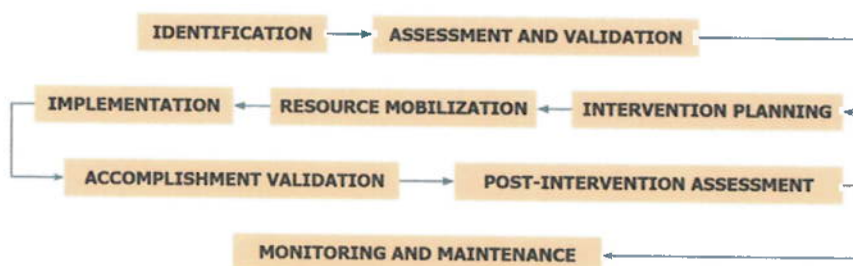
F. District Engineering Offices

District Engineering Offices shall serve as the principal field implementing units of OKB within their respective areas of jurisdiction, unless otherwise directed pursuant to existing authority. They shall conduct assessment and validation, prepare intervention and resource requirements, implement authorized activities, coordinate with stakeholders, maintain verifiable accomplishment records, conduct post-intervention inspection, and refer matters beyond their mandate to the appropriate office or agency.

G. Concerned DPWH Bureaus, Services, Offices, and Implementing Units

Concerned offices shall provide technical, equipment, administrative, financial, legal, procurement, logistical, and other support within their respective mandates and authorities.

VI. OPERATIONAL CYCLE



A. Identification

Potential intervention areas may be identified through regular DPWH field inspection and monitoring, historical and current flooding information, reports from DPWH offices, reports or requests from LGUs and communities, lawful directives, established government information systems, and other reliable and verifiable sources.

B. Assessment and Validation

Reported or identified conditions shall be validated through field inspection or other appropriate technical means. Assessment shall determine, where applicable, the nature and extent of the problem, degree of obstruction, estimated quantities, drainage or hydraulic condition, flood history, population and critical facilities affected, resource requirements, access, hauling and disposal requirements, environmental and jurisdictional considerations, and whether the condition is within the scope of OKB.

C. Intervention Planning

For priority areas, the implementing office shall prepare an operational plan proportionate to the scale and complexity of the intervention, identifying the location, problem, proposed intervention, target output, responsible office, equipment and manpower requirements and payment for wages, hauling and disposal arrangements, access and staging requirements, coordination and permitting requirements, safety requirements, implementation schedule, and

monitoring arrangements. Urgent operations may use simplified documentation when immediate action is required, subject to subsequent documentation and reporting.

D. Resource Mobilization and Augmentation

Available resources of the concerned implementing office shall be utilized first, whenever practicable. Where requirements exceed available resources, augmentation may be coordinated at the Regional-level and, when necessary, elevated to the OKB Task Force for appropriate coordination.

Equipment deployment shall consider suitability to actual site conditions, accessibility, mobilization requirements, equipment condition, operator availability, water and tidal conditions where applicable, safety, fuel, maintenance requirements, and other operational constraints. Equipment deployment shall correspond to a validated operational requirement and shall not, by itself, constitute an accomplishment indicator.

E. Implementation of Field Operations

Field operations shall be undertaken in accordance with applicable engineering, environmental, occupational safety, traffic, and operational requirements. Operations may be adjusted based on actual field conditions, weather, water level, tidal conditions, equipment performance, safety requirements, and other factors affecting implementation. Where conditions create an immediate danger to personnel or equipment, operations may be suspended or modified until appropriate safety measures can be established.

F. Accomplishment Validation and Data Integrity

All reported accomplishments shall be supported by appropriate documentation, including as applicable geotagged before, during, and after photographs; geographic coordinates; actual length or area cleared; actual volume of materials removed; equipment and operating hours; manpower; hauling and disposal records; dates of operations; and relevant field documentation.

Reported quantities shall reflect actual field accomplishment. Estimated quantities may be used for planning purposes but shall be distinguished from actual accomplishment data. Where truckloads are used as an accomplishment measure, the corresponding vehicle capacity and reasonable volumetric basis shall be documented.

G. Post-Intervention Assessment .

Upon completion, the implementing office shall determine whether the identified obstruction or deficiency was adequately addressed, functionality was restored or improved, additional work is required, the condition is likely to recur, source-control or inter-agency intervention is necessary, structural intervention is required, and the area should be incorporated into a periodic maintenance schedule.

H. Monitoring and Reporting System

A uniform OKB monitoring and reporting system shall be established. Reports shall contain, as applicable, location and coordinates, facility concerned, identified problem, priority classification, intervention undertaken, implementation dates, resources utilized, actual quantities accomplished, before and after conditions, hauling and disposal information, operational constraints, required follow-up action, and recommended maintenance schedule.

Regional Offices shall consolidate reports from their District Engineering Offices. The OKB Task Force shall maintain a consolidated national monitoring system to support program management, resource allocation, evaluation, and reporting to the Secretary.

VII. PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

OKB performance shall be evaluated based on both outputs and outcomes. Output indicators may include lengths cleared or desilted, volume of materials removed, number of priority areas addressed, facilities maintained or rehabilitated, and percentage of programmed interventions completed. Outcome indicators may include restoration of functionality, reduction of critical obstruction, reduction in recurrence, improved response time, compliance with maintenance schedules, and reduction in flood duration, depth, or extent where measurable and reasonably attributable to the intervention. Performance shall not be measured solely by the number of personnel or equipment deployed.

VIII. PREVENTIVE AND PERIODIC MAINTENANCE

Completed intervention areas shall be evaluated for inclusion in an appropriate monitoring and maintenance program. Maintenance frequency shall consider flood risk, hydraulic significance, rate of siltation, solid waste accumulation, recurrence, population affected, and operational importance.

A. Routine Maintenance

Regularly scheduled cleaning, clearing, inspection, and minor maintenance necessary to preserve functionality.

B. Pre-Rainy Season Maintenance

Preventive intervention undertaken before periods of expected heavy rainfall.

C. Post-Event Maintenance

Inspection and necessary clearing following typhoons, major rainfall events, flooding, or similar occurrences.

D. Condition-Based Maintenance

Intervention initiated when monitoring indicates that siltation, obstruction, deterioration, or waste accumulation has reached a level requiring action.

E. Urgent or Emergency Intervention

Immediate operations undertaken in response to an imminent or ongoing threat to public safety, critical infrastructure, or severe flooding.

IX. ESCALATION OF STRUCTURAL AND SYSTEMIC ISSUES

OKB shall principally address flooding conditions that may be corrected or mitigated through clearing, dredging, desilting, declogging, rehabilitation, maintenance, and related operational measures. Conditions caused by insufficient capacity, major structural deficiency, absence of necessary infrastructure, significant right-of-way constraints, major encroachments, land-use conditions, watershed degradation, major pumping or conveyance deficiencies, or other

matters beyond regular maintenance shall be documented and referred to the appropriate DPWH office, LGU, national government agency, or responsible entity for appropriate action. Pending long-term intervention, appropriate interim OKB measures may continue where technically feasible and beneficial.

X. INTER-AGENCY, LGU, PRIVATE-SECTOR, AND COMMUNITY PARTICIPATION

The OKB Task Force and implementing offices shall promote coordinated participation of concerned government agencies, LGUs, barangays, communities, private-sector entities, and other stakeholders on matters such as solid waste management, environmental protection and permitting, easements and encroachments, hauling and disposal, traffic management, public safety, community mobilization, utilities, equipment, and logistics. For operational clarity, the roles and responsibilities of implementing and partner entities shall include the following: (a) DPWH implementing offices shall undertake technical assessment, planning, implementation, equipment and manpower deployment, monitoring, validation, and reporting of authorized OKB interventions; (b) concerned LGUs and barangays shall support local drainage and waterway maintenance, solid waste source control, access, traffic and community coordination, hauling and lawful disposal arrangements, and the enforcement of applicable local ordinances; (c) national government agencies and other partner agencies shall provide permits, technical assistance, environmental safeguards, enforcement, utilities coordination, equipment, logistics, and other support within their respective mandates; and (d) private-sector entities and communities may support information sharing, mobilization, site access, waste reduction, monitoring, and other agreed activities consistent with applicable laws.

Participation by another entity shall not diminish or transfer the statutory mandate, jurisdiction, or accountability of the responsible government office.

XI. FUNDING AND RESOURCE PROGRAMMING

Implementation of OKB shall be subject to the availability of funds and applicable budgeting, accounting, auditing, procurement, and other government rules and regulations. Concerned offices shall identify recurring maintenance, equipment, payment of wages to maintenance personnel, hauling, disposal, fuel, and other operational requirements for consideration in their regular planning, programming, and budgeting processes.

XII. OKB INFORMATION AND DATA MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

A consolidated OKB information and data management system shall be maintained to support operational planning, decision-making, resource allocation, monitoring, and evaluation. Geospatial information and mapping shall be utilized whenever practicable to identify patterns, recurring hotspots, upstream-downstream relationships, and areas requiring coordinated intervention.

XIII. PROGRAM EVALUATION AND CONTINUOUS IMPROVEMENT

The OKB Task Force shall periodically evaluate program implementation based on accomplishment and performance data, effectiveness of interventions, recurrence of flooding and obstruction, resource utilization, operational constraints, field experience, inter-agency

coordination issues, changes in laws and policies, and technological and operational developments.

XIV. IMPLEMENTING GUIDELINES AND STANDARD FORMS

To ensure uniform Department-wide implementation, the OKB Task Force, through the appropriate DPWH offices and subject to existing authorities, may develop or recommend standard implementing guidelines, forms, and templates for site assessment, prioritization, intervention planning, equipment deployment, accomplishment reporting, waste hauling and disposal, before-and-after documentation, post-intervention assessment, preventive maintenance, consolidated reporting, and national monitoring.

XV. PERIODIC REVIEW OF THE FRAMEWORK

This Operational Framework shall be periodically reviewed to ensure its continuing relevance, effectiveness, and consistency with Department policies, applicable laws, national flood management strategies, and actual implementation experience. Necessary amendments or supplemental guidelines may be recommended to the Secretary.

XVI. IMPLEMENTATION

Upon approval by the Secretary, this Operational Framework shall serve as the Department-wide framework for the coordinated planning, prioritization, implementation, monitoring, evaluation, and sustained maintenance of OKB interventions nationwide.

All concerned DPWH offices and implementing units shall align their OKB activities with this Framework and such implementing guidelines as may subsequently be issued. All activities undertaken pursuant to this Framework shall remain subject to existing laws, rules, regulations, Department issuances, and applicable government budgeting, accounting, auditing, procurement, environmental, occupational safety, and other requirements.

Nothing herein shall be construed as modifying the statutory mandates, jurisdiction, administrative authority, or accountability of any DPWH office, national government agency, or local government unit unless expressly authorized by law or appropriate issuance.

For your information and strict implementation.


VIVENCIO B. DIZON
Secretary

9.1 TNLI/CTCJ

Department of Public Works and Highways
Office of the Secretary



SVBD-2026-05062